HOORVIA - CHICKEN INTERNAL TEMPERATURE CHART (WHITE VS DARK MEAT GUIDE)

Quick Reference Cheat Sheet · US Letter Printable

Kitchen & Cooking

Boneless Skinless Breast			
Meat Type	**Pull From Heat At**	**Final Rested Temp**	**Rest Time & Texture Goal**
Lean White	158°F-160°F / 70°C	165°F / 74°C	Rest 5 min tented; prevents dry stringiness

Bone-In Split Breast			
Meat Type	**Pull From Heat At**	**Final Rested Temp**	**Rest Time & Texture Goal**
White + Bone	160°F-162°F / 71°C	165°F / 74°C	Rest 7 min; bone conducts heat into center

Chicken Tenderloins / Strips			
Meat Type	**Pull From Heat At**	**Final Rested Temp**	**Rest Time & Texture Goal**
Lean White	162°F / 72°C	165°F / 74°C	Rest 3 min; thin cuts have minimal carryover

Boneless Skinless Thighs			
Meat Type	**Pull From Heat At**	**Final Rested Temp**	**Rest Time & Texture Goal**
Rich Dark	172°F-175°F / 78°C	178°F / 81°C	Rest 5 min; melts tough connective tissue

Bone-In Thighs & Drumsticks			
Meat Type	**Pull From Heat At**	**Final Rested Temp**	**Rest Time & Texture Goal**
Dark + Bone	175°F-180°F / 79°C	182°F-185°F / 85°C	Rest 5 min; eliminates bloody/pink joints

Chicken Wings (Flats & Drums)			
Meat Type	**Pull From Heat At**	**Final Rested Temp**	**Rest Time & Texture Goal**
Dark + Skin	185°F-190°F / 85°C	190°F+ / 88°C	High temp renders subcutaneous wing fat crisp

Whole Roast Chicken (3.5-4 lb)			
Meat Type	**Pull From Heat At**	**Final Rested Temp**	**Rest Time & Texture Goal**
Mixed Bird	160°F / 71°C (Breast) / 175°F / 79°C (Thigh)	165°F / 74°C / 180°F / 82°C	Rest 15-20 min before carving so juices settle

Ground Chicken Burgers / Loaf			
Meat Type	**Pull From Heat At**	**Final Rested Temp**	**Rest Time & Texture Goal**
Minced	162°F / 72°C	165°F / 74°C (Mandatory)	Rest 4 min; ground poultry must reach 165°F / 74°C

PRO TIP: A whole chicken is two completely different meats attached to one frame. Understanding the structural difference between pectoral flight muscles (white meat) and leg locomotion muscles (dark meat) transforms how you cook poultry: